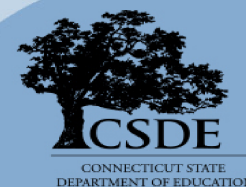


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



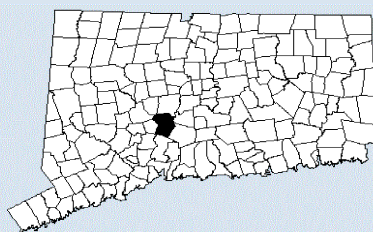
Cheshire School District

Dr. Jeffrey Solan, Superintendent • 203-250-2400 • www.cheshire.k12.ct.us/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	13
Enrollment	4,193
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$18,372
Total Expenditures ¹	\$76,483,030

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.5
Male	2,138	51.0	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	389	9.3	5.1
Black or African American	134	3.2	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	311	7.4	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	*	*	4.3
White	3,229	77.0	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	95	2.3	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	630	15.0	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	577	13.8	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	20	1.0
Male	221	10.6	59	2.7
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	21	15.6	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	51	16.4	14	4.1
White	302	9.6	53	1.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	11	10.1	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	137	21.5	30	4.4
Students with Disabilities	129	23.8	34	5.2
District	430	10.4	79	1.8
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 554

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Cheshire School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	274.7
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	36.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	54.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	137.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	4.0
School Level	21.8
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	4.8
Support Staff	4.8
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	18.7
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	27.9
School Nurses	8.9
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	203.2

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.5	1.3
Black or African American	3	0.7	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	7	1.7	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	397	97.1	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	10.5	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	9	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	23	92.0	19	90.5
White	245	98.0	301	98.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	45	93.8	49	96.1
Students with Disabilities	45	97.8	60	93.8
District	323	97.3	382	97.9
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	39	54.2
Emotional Disturbance	24	61.5
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	128	69.9
Other Health Impairment	90	67.2
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	32	84.2
District	321	62.7
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Cheshire School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	77	1.9	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	39	0.9	1.1
Intellectual Disability	22	0.5	0.6
Learning Disability	183	4.4	6.1
Other Health Impairment	138	3.4	3.3
Other Disabilities	41	1.0	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	47	1.1	1.9
All Disabilities	547	13.3	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	8	1.5	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	11	2.0	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$47,205,920	\$11,339	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$6,372,352	\$1,551	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$3,431,771	\$835	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$886,207	\$216	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$3,583,194	\$872	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$2,356,450	\$573	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$7,877,680	\$1,917	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$3,789,464	\$1,356	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	\$979,993	\$238	\$170
Total	\$76,483,030	\$18,372	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,164,688	38.9	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,480,820	13.5	10.8
Other Salaries	\$2,097,648	11.4	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$3,120,009	16.9	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$664,576	3.6	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$1,933,820	10.5	22.6
Supplies	\$224,536	1.2	0.6
Property Services	\$46,983	0.3	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$694,739	3.8	6.3
Equipment	.	.	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$1,000	0.0	0.1
Total	\$18,428,819	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.1	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	84.0
State	13.2
Federal	2.3
Tuition & Other	0.5

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Cheshire School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	204	85.7	203	85.8	97	84.9
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	28	63.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	147	70.7	147	64.7	69	65.4
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	70	76.4	70	76.4	*	*
White	1,615	76.4	1,613	73.6	693	72.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	60	66.0	60	65.2	24	63.9
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,046	77.0	2,041	74.2	886	73.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	328	69.0	328	65.3	146	63.8
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,778	78.1	1,773	75.5	764	74.8
Students with Disabilities	242	55.2	240	49.8	114	54.0
Students without Disabilities	1,864	79.4	1,861	77.0	796	75.8
High Needs	527	65.4	525	61.5	229	62.3
Non-High Needs	1,579	80.4	1,576	78.1	681	76.7
District	2,106	76.6	2,101	73.9	910	73.0

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	84.0	77.2	70.5	90.1	1,218	80.2
Curl Up	92.6	86.3	86.7	91.2	1,218	89.2
Push Up	83.0	75.6	77.1	87.3	1,218	80.6
Mile Run/PACER	72.4	79.2	79.0	72.2	1,218	75.8
All Tests - District	58.3	54.4	54.0	68.3	1,218	58.5
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Cheshire School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	9	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	*
White	296	96.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	60	91.7
Students with Disabilities	52	82.7
District	362	97.0
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	95.5	238	63.0
Male	96.5	200	58.1
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	95.5	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	93.5	18	39.1
White	96.4	336	60.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	91.9	40	40.4
Students with Disabilities	76.4	6	5.5
District	96.0	438	60.7
State	95.0		43.5

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2022 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2022 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2022

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	89.7	95.2
Male	73.6	93.9
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	79.8	95.1
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	62.7	89.5
Students with Disabilities	47.2	*
District	81.8	94.6
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Cheshire School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	76.6	75	50.0	50	100.0	64.2
	High Needs Students	65.4	75	43.6	50	87.2	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	73.9	75	49.3	50	98.6	58.6
	High Needs Students	61.5	75	41.0	50	82.0	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	73.0	75	48.7	50	97.4	61.4
	High Needs Students	62.3	75	41.5	50	83.1	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	60.1%	100%	60.1	100	60.1	60.4%
	High Needs Students	53.4%	100%	53.4	100	53.4	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	68.9%	100%	68.9	100	68.9	65.2%
	High Needs Students	61.4%	100%	61.4	100	61.4	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	79.1%	100%	39.5	50	79.1	64.9%
	Oral	74.7%	100%	37.4	50	74.7	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	10.4%	<=5%	39.1	50	78.2	23.7%
	High Needs Students	20.4%	<=5%	19.3	50	38.5	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	97.6%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	60.7%	75%	40.4	50	80.9	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		92.4%	94%	49.2	50	98.3	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		97.0%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		95.7%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		81.8%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		97.6% 58.5%	75%	39.0	50	78.0	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		51.0%	60%	42.5	50	85.0	52.4%
Accountability Index				1174.2	1450	81.0	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	65.4	9.6	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.5	13.5	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	62.3	12.7	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	95.7%	-1.7%	10.2%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.1
	High Needs Students	95.4
Math	All Students	97.9
	High Needs Students	94.9
Science	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	96.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 62.0

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Cheshire School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Cheshire Public Schools created 16 strategic goals in 2011 which were slated to be reviewed in 2021. The pandemic derailed those plans last year so working with the community to establish revised goals was a focus of the 2021-2022 school year. There were meetings held at each school to connect with parents about the goals of the district. Families provided feedback to district leaders on which goals were most critical. We also used this opportunity to solicit feedback on the improvement of school programs and coached families on strategies to best support their children at home. The Board of Education will meet in the fall of 2022 to adopt a revised set of goals for the future.

The Cheshire Public Schools continued to leverage new strategies identified over the pandemic to connect with our community. Over the 2021-22 school year, the district had a very active social media presence on Twitter, Instagram, and Facebook in order to share timely, pertinent information about our schools. We continued to utilize our newly created webpage that was devoted exclusively to pandemic-related resources and instructional supports. Parents were easily able to track the number of student and staff COVID-19 cases in the district on a daily basis. Parent communication was a top priority as we strived to support parents and students. District communication included email, school messenger, social media, video messages from the Superintendent, Board of Education live-streamed meetings, and the COVID-19 email hotline for parents to ask questions.

Communication was also critical to support community understanding of the pending proposal to modernize the Cheshire Public Schools. Numerous in-person and virtual meetings were held throughout the year to provide updates on the progress of this proposal. A revised webpage was provided with a QR code link that was widely distributed across town. Subsequently, the video describing the project has received more than 1000 views.

Our district improvement was focused exclusively on meeting the academic and social-emotional needs of our students. We developed a "Bounce Forward" Plan with our federal funding to provide resources to our students and professional development for our staff. On the SEL side, we focused on regular communication and support to students and families. We provided training to staff including Mental Health First Aid and responsive classroom coaching. Academically, we provided professional development and coaching in Accelerated Learning (a focus on maintaining student progress on grade level material rather than trying to recapture lost time). This work supports all students, particularly those students with more significant needs.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

CPS actively participates in the Open Choice program, as well as magnet opportunities. Over 35 students from New Haven are enrolled in Cheshire schools. We believe that these exchanges provide enriching experiences for all of our students. As such, we increased our open choice enrollment by over 30% in 2021-22 from the previous year.

At the elementary level, we build a classroom community based on equality, respect, and understanding of each other's unique backgrounds. Grades K-2 study and compare cultures. In Grades 3-6, culture, diversity, and understanding perspective are embedded in units on local history, and comparative cultures around the world.

At the middle school, the language arts curriculum is based on an independent reading program where students choose a wide variety of texts and authors of all different races and ethnicities. Discussion around the perspective of each author and the experience of each individual in the context of society inform the reader and class as a whole.

CHS engages in a variety of academic and co-curricular pursuits to reduce ethnic, racial, and economic isolation. Students in our English classes explore connections between fictional texts and real-world events, which offer opportunities to explore race, socioeconomic issues, and isolation. The department contextualizes literary choices within their social and political contexts. Our social studies classes focus on themes that include human rights struggles around the globe, cultural diversity as part of our American national identity, and the struggle for freedom, equality, and social justice. We were also among the first high schools in Connecticut to offer the new Black and Latino Studies Course. Clubs like Rams Against Racism Club and the Gender-Sexuality Alliance Club continued to play active roles in our community.

Districtwide, we continue to work on our SEL goal including cultural awareness with partners such as SCSU, Meriden Public Schools, and SERC. We actively recruit a diverse workforce and work to educate our staff and community on the importance of an inclusive and diverse environment for our students. We are excited to be participating in the ACES program to diversify our workforce by training a teacher to join us next year.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Cheshire School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Cheshire Board of Education Policy states that each student in the school district shall be supplied with the appropriate level of material and resources to assure adequate opportunities to achieve academic success. Schools develop their resource needs based on curricular programs and annual strategic initiatives in the school strategic plan. Those strategic initiatives are connected to the major objectives set forth by the Board in its strategic plan. This process assures there is continuity among individual school plans. Principals and central office administrators work collaboratively to develop budgets for instructional resources to support teaching and learning. Although supplies are allocated based on curriculum needs, enrollment, and a per pupil average at each grade level, in some years a school may receive greater funding than others due to changes in enrollment, specific needs, or unique circumstances. Students with special needs are evaluated on an individual basis and decisions to provide adequate support and to purchase appropriate materials, supplies, and equipment to meet their individual education programs are based on that information.